

OUT OF THE PAST

A PROFESSIONAL OBSERVATION

TYPE CE I-II
DATE: JAN. 18, 1966
TIME: 4:55 P.M. PST
DURATION: 1 MIN (20 MIN.)
WITNESSES: Two
PLACE: CHINA LAKE, CA.

A CIVILIAN RECENTLY EMPLOYED AT THE CHINA LAKE NAVAL ORDNANCE TEST STATION, IN CALIFORNIA, UNEARTHED (METHOD NOT RELATED) A UFO REPORT MADE (AND BURIED IN THE FILES) SOME SIXTEEN YEARS AGO. THE REPORT ITSELF IS UNCLASSIFIED. PROBABLY IT WENT FROM DESK DIRECTLY TO FILES AND NOTHING MORE WAS DONE ABOUT IT.

SINCE IT ORIGINATED AT A WEAPONS TEST STATION, ONE IMMEDIATELY WONDERS WHETHER A SECRET WEAPON WAS BEING DESCRIBED, FOR IT OFTEN HAPPENS AT SUCH INSTALLATIONS THAT THE PROVERBIAL RIGHT HAND DOESN'T KNOW WHAT THE LEFT HAND IS DOING. BUT DID WE HAVE ANYTHING LIKE THIS IN 1966?

THE REPORT CAME TO THE ATTENTION OF CUFOS IN A CIRCUITOUS MANNER; IT FOLLOWS HERE ALMOST IN ITS ENTIRETY BECAUSE OF ITS PROFESSIONAL NATURE:

"ON TUESDAY, 18 JAN. 1966, AT 4:55 P.M. PST, ON BAKER RANGE AT THE NAVAL ORDNANCE STATION, TWO CIVIL SERVICE-EMPLOYED SURVEYORS WERE INVOLVED IN SIGHTING A UFO. ONE MAN WAS STANDING AT A BENCH-MARK MONUMENT, ABOUT 117 DEG. W., 35 DEG 52 MIN N. AT 3004 FT. ABOVE SEA LEVEL, USING A WILD T-3 THEODOLITE IN A SURVEY OF POINTS IN THE AREA. TWO OF THEIR TARGETS WERE IN LINE WITH THE BIC FLIGHT LINE, ONE BEING A BLINKING FLASH LAMP ABOUT 5 MILES DISTANT, LOCATED ON THE FAR SIDE OF AN ANCIENT LAVA FLOW.

" ONE MAN WAS TAKING READINGS WITH THE THEODOLITE; THE OTHER WAS SITTING IN

THE TRUCK RECORDING THE READINGS. THE FIRST MAN HEARD A NOISE DESCRIBED AS A 'KIND OF HUM' BUT ALSO LIKE A JET PLANE CRUISING AT HIGH ALTITUDE. LOOKING UP HE SAW A UFO FLYING NEARLY STRAIGHT AT HIM FROM AN ANGLE OF BETWEEN 35 AND 40 DEGREES AND FROM ALMOST EXACTLY NORTH. THE UFO PASSED DIRECTLY OVERHEAD (BEING SURVEYORS THEY PROBABLY REALLY MEANT 'OVERHEAD', A VERY LOOSELY USED TERM BY THE LAYMAN) AT A HEIGHT OF MUCH LESS THAN 150 FEET. DIVING SMOOTHLY IT APPEARED TO TURN SLIGHTLY TO THE EAST AND CAME TO WITHIN ABOUT 10 FEET OF THE SLOPING GROUND, DOWN THE FLIGHT LINE, BUT PERHAPS 10 FEET TO THE EAST OF THE CENTER OF THE FLIGHT LINE (SEE SKETCH).

" AFTER IT PASSED OVERHEAD THE FIRST OBSERVER LOOSENED THE ELEVATION LOCK ON THE THEODOLITE AND AIMED THE 40X SIGHTING TELESCOPE ON THE UFO, OBSERVING IT AS IT FLEW DOWN THE FLIGHT LINE UNTIL ITS DETAIL BECAME LOST IN FRONT OF THE LAVA FLOW, ABOUT TWO MILES AWAY.

"BOTH OBSERVERS AGREE THAT THE SPEED WAS ABOUT 150 MPH AS IT PASSED OVERHEAD AND THAT IT WAS A DULL BLACK COLOR. THERE WERE NO NOTICEABLE CONTROL SURFACES AND NO LIGHTS VISIBLE (SEE SKETCHES). THE FIRST MAN DESCRIBED THE UFO AS A THING OF GREAT BEAUTY IN SHAPE AND MOVEMENT. IT WAS VERY QUIET (REMARKABLE FOR AN AIRCRAFT JUST 150 FEET AWAY). NO HEAT WAS FELT. BOTH MEN AGREED ON THE SIZE OF THE OBJECT (12X8X1^{FL}) AND THAT THE BOTTOM WAS FLAT.

"THE FIRST OBSERVER WAS SOMEWHAT RELUCTANT TO REPORT SEEING A 'WAKE' BEHIND THE UFO. IT WAS AS IF THE REAR SECTION WAS DISTURBING THE SURROUNDING AIR... SOMETHING LIKE A PLANE 'DUMPING FUEL'. IT WAS MORE LIKE A SCHIEREN^L PATTERN^X OBSERVED IN A WIND TUNNEL. HIS HESITANCY RESULTED FROM THE BELIEF THAT IT WAS IMPOSSIBLE TO SEE TURBULENCE OR SHOCK WAVE WITH THE UNAIDED EYE.

"THE MEN IMMEDIATELY ATTEMPTED TO RADIO A REPORT INTO THE RANGE CONTROL OFFICE. THE RADIOMAN IN THE OFFICE HEARD THEIR CALL AS VERY GARBLED, AS IF IT WERE BEING JAMMED. A FEW^F WORDS DID GET THROUGH. THEY WERE ABLE, HOWEVER, TO

SCHLIERE

HEAR THE CONTROL OFFICE TRANSMISSION WITHOUT TROUBLE, EVEN THOUGH THEIR OWN TRANSMISSION CONTINUED TO BE GARBLED FOR SOME TIME. AFTER HAVING NO SUCCESS AT RADIO REPORTING, THEY ATTEMPTED TO START THE TRUCK, BUT WITH NO SUCCESS. THE STARTER MOTOR WOULD BARELY TURN THE ENGINE OVER AND THE ENGINE WOULD NOT CATCH. 'THEY DECIDED TO FINISH THEIR THEODOLITE READINGS AND DID SO IN ABOUT FIVE MINUTES, AND THEN STORED THEIR GEAR. THEY PUSHED THE TRUCK DOWN THE HILL TO GET IT STARTED. IT RAN POORLY AS THEY DROVE TO THE LAVA FLOW TO MAKE SOME OBSERVATIONS THERE. FROM THE TIME OF THE UFO OVERFLIGHT TO THIS TIME WAS LESS THAN 20 MINUTES'

IT IS NOT KNOWN WHO WROTE THE REPORT. IT VERY WELL COULD HAVE BEEN THE OBSERVERS THEMSELVES WHO PREFERRED TO USE THE THIRD PERSON TO MAKE IT LESS DIRECT AND PERSONAL. THE REPORT CONTINUES WITH A POINT THAT MIGHT POSSIBLY BE RELEVANT:

'AFTER THE OVERFLIGHT, IT WAS NECESSARY TO RE-LEVEL THE THEODOLITE. IT HAD MOVED TO THE WEST BY 5 LEVEL GRADATIONS. THE OPERATOR INSISTS THAT HE DID NOT PUT ENOUGH FORCE ON THE THEODOLITE TO CAUSE THIS MISLEVEL; THE PLUMB BOB INDICATED THE INSTRUMENT WAS STILL CENTERED OVER THE PRICK-PUNCH REFERENCE ON THE BENCH MARK. IF HE HAD KICKED THE TRIPOD, THE PLUMB BOB WOULD ALMOST CERTAINLY HAVE BEEN MISALIGNED. FURTHER, WITH HIS EXPERIENCE IN SURVEYING OPERATIONS AND THE LACK OF PHYSICAL MOVEMENT REQUIRED TO FOLLOW THE UFO WITH THE TELESCOPE, IT IS VERY UNLIKELY THAT HE HAD EXERTED ANY APPRECIABLE FORCE ON THE INSTRUMENT. NO PLAUSIBLE EXPLANATION HAS BEEN OFFERED FOR THE CHANGE IN THE GRAVITY REFERENCE INDICATOR....THE BUBBLE IN A SPIRIT VIAL.

'IT IS PROBABLE THAT THESE ESTIMATES OF SIZE, HEIGHT, AND SPEED ARE AS RELIABLE AS ANY REPORTED TO DATE BECAUSE MEASUREMENT OF OBJECTS AND DISTANCES IS THE DAILY WORK OF THESE SURVEYORS. THEIR INTEGRITY IS EXCELLENT'

WHAT, THEN, SHALL BE THE VERDICT? A DELIBERATE HOAX, PLACED IN THE FILES TO GATHER DUST

FOR YEARS? OR, MORE LIKELY, A REPORT MADE IN GOOD FAITH OUT OF A SENSE OF DUTY, SUBMITTED TO HIGHER AUTHORITIES WHO THEN QUIETLY FILED IT? I HAVE TALKED AT LENGTH WITH THE CIVILIAN EMPLOYEE WHO DISCOVERED THE EXISTENCE OF THE REPORT, WHO THEN SENT IT TO AN UNCLE IN NEW YORK, WHO THEN IN TURN SENT IT ON TO THE CENTER. I LEARNED SOMETHING OF ITS HISTORY. THE REPORT WAS FILED, THE EMPLOYEE TELLS ME HE WAS ABLE TO FIND OUT, IN GOOD FAITH AND WITH SERIOUS INTENT IN THE HOPE THAT THE OFFICIALS AT THE BASE WOULD SUBMIT IT TO HIGHER AUTHORITIES IN THE GOVERNMENT. APPARENTLY NOTHING WAS DONE. THE CENTER WILL ATTEMPT TO PROBE A LITTLE DEEPER INTO THIS CASE, BUT SIXTEEN YEARS HAVE ELAPSED AND THE TRAIL IS COLD. ANY FURTHER DEVELOPMENTS WILL, OF COURSE, BE REPORTED IN THIS PUBLICATION.

For LHM or Bulletin

From out of the post.

July 1, 1981

Used

Dear [REDACTED]:

I enclose a "UFO REPORT" that was sent to me by my nephew. who is a civilian employee at China Lake Ordnance Test Station, in California.

NAVAL

I don't know how or where he got the copy, so if you make any inquiries at the Center in order to develop more details, please use discretion, since I don't want to jeopardize his job there.

The copy is not very clear, and the report, in addition to being handwritten, contains misspellings and is almost incoherent in spots, but this is all I have available.

With your greater resources, you might be able to consider this report worthwhile following up.

I don't know if my nephew wants to get involved in a UFO investigation, but his name and address are:

[REDACTED]
1 [REDACTED] ELLIS,

5

Cool

Dist. new info

SR-21

Out of the post

Good

[REDACTED]

18/Jan/66

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UFO REPORT

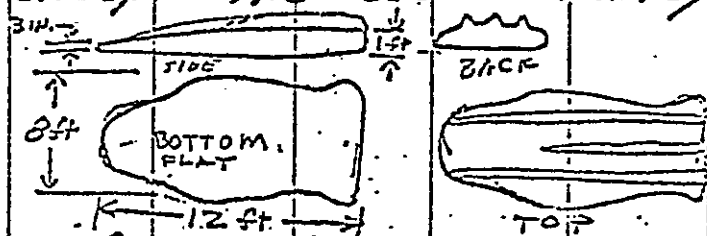
On Tuesday, 18 Jan 1966, at 4:55 pm Pacific Std. Time, on Baker Range at the U.S. Naval Ordnance Test Station, two civil service employed surveyors were involved in sighting a UFO. One man was standing at a bench mark monument $117^{\circ} 49' 12''$ west longitude $35^{\circ} 52'$ north latitude at 3004 ft above sea level using a Wild T-3 theodolite in a survey of points in the area. Two of their targets were in line with the BIC Flight line, one being a blinking flash lamp about 5 miles S by SSE at a point on the flight line call target central and labeled TC on some maps. A profile of the line of sight to TC is something like:

One man was taking readings with the theodolite while the other sat in the truck, a weapons carrier, recording the reading as they were called by the first man. The first man heard a noise described as a "kind of hum" but also like a jet plane cruising at high altitude. He looked up and on backward to see a UFO flying nearly straight at him from an angle of between 35 and 40 degrees and from almost exactly north. He called the second man to "look" as the UFO passed directly overhead at a height of much less than 150 ft. Diving smoothly it appeared to turn slightly to the east and flew to within about 10 ft of the sloping ground, down the flight line but perhaps a constant 10 ft east of the center of the flight line.

After it passed overhead the first observer loosened the elevation lock on the theodolite and aimed the 40x sighting telescope on the UFO, observing it as it

flew down the flight line until its detail became lost in front of the lava flow, about 2 miles away and on the flight line.

Both observers agree the speed was about 150 mph as it passed overhead. Both agree it was a dull black color, there were no noticeable control surfaces, no visible lights and on the configuration, except the second observer noticed only two



fins instead of three. The first man described the UFO as a thing of great beauty in its shape and movement.

The noise was very quiet. No heat was experienced by the observers (they had on winter coats). The first observer was somewhat reluctant to report seeing a "wake" behind the UFO. It was as if the rear section was disturbing the surrounding air — something like a plane "dumping fuel" in configuration, like  reality opaque, but was a shock wave seen in apparatus in a wind tunnel. His hesitancy was a result of believing it impossible to see turbulence or shock wave with the unaided eye. Both men agreed on size and that the bottom was flat.

The darkened area was not in more like a schlieren

The men immediately attempted to radio a report into the range control office. The radioman in the office heard their call as very garbled, as if jammed (?). A few words did get through. The operator spoke a few curt words which were received clearly on the truck radio. This interference prevented

for perhaps 20 minutes after the UFO passed overhead.

After no success at radio reporting, they attempted to start the truck with no success. The starter motor (24 volts) would barely turn the engine over and the engine would not catch.

They decided to finish their reading from this point and did so in about 5 minutes. They picked up the theodolite and pushed the truck down the hill to get it started. It ran poorly as they drove to the lava flow to make some more survey readings. After climbing to the survey monument atop the lava, they observed that the blinking light at TC was out. From the UFO overflight to this time was less than 20 minutes. They returned to the truck, whose engine they had left in a fast idle, to find the engine now running smoothly.

The drove back to near the point of the overflight, picked up another light, and drove to the TC point. As they approached, the light resumed blinking.

After the overflight, it was necessary to relevel the theodolite. It was observed to be misleveled 5 graduations, having moved toward the west. The first surveyor insists he did not put enough force on the theodolite to cause this mislevel and the plumb string indicated the instrument was still centered over the prick-punch reference on the bench mark. If he had kicked the tripod, the plumb bob would likely be misaligned. Further, with his experience in this operation and the lack of physical movement required to follow the UFO with the telescope, it is very unlikely

that he had exerted any appreciable force on the instrument. No plausible explanation has been offered for the change in the gravity reference indicator - a bubble in a spirit vial.

It is probable that these estimates of size, height, and speed are as reliable as any reported to date because measurement of objects and distances is their daily work. Their integrity is excellent.

A similar UFO was sighted by a NOTS security patrolman who was checking the boundary gate on the Leliter road on the previous Tuesday. It was after dark and the UFO was illuminated but did not have any apparent individual lights. While observing it, the patrolman indicated it suddenly changed direction and quickly accelerated out of sight.